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DIGITAL IMMORTALITY: PRESERVING HUMAN CONSCIOUSNESS THROUGH ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

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ABSTRACT

Digital immortality is defined as digital data which enables human consciousness to survive after biological death using artificial intelligence and complex computational algorithms. Unlike the classical ideas of immortality cognate to myth, this process is based on data, memory, and forms of cognitive simulation. Today's AI can simulate conscious behaviors such as patterns of thought, habitual responses, and decisions through deep learning and natural language processing. Neuroscience bridges the gap about information by providing a map of neural networks and thus, a means for reconstructing memory and a means to simulate thought patterns. together, brain-computer interfaces, generative AI, and means for memory storage may allow ways for us to live in digital spaces upon death. This paper examines the underlying technology, research currently underway, ethical contexts, and models on how digital immortality could be achieved. It also investigates current issues related to identity, privacy, and authenticity and anticipates future uses of digital immortality toward healthcare, legacy, and transhumanism. Overall, digital immortality is no longer a speculative science-fiction; it is a very real research horizon that may change humanity's views on life and death.

INTRODUCTION

For thousands of years, humankind has daydreamed of gaining immortality. Be it mythology, religion, or philosophical speculation, people have been preoccupied in every age with the pursuit or immunity from death. The Epic of Gilgamesh contains examples of this pursuit and the Fountain of Youth is another great example. More recently, this concept of immortality has also been explored through science fiction, often imagining realities in which human experience continues after the body has ceased to exist.

In the last few decades, breakthroughs in neuroscience, AI, and biotechnology have begun to make this ancient dream potentially achievable. One of the most exciting and controversial possibilities in this area is referred to sometimes as 'digital immortality' or simply 'digital transcendence' (broadly defined as the preservation, reproduction or simulation of human consciousness, personality, and memories via computational technologies). Unlike biological preservation, digital immotability refers to our desire to rise above the limitations of our human bodies by simulating or replicating our cognitive processes as digital processes.